

Legislation on Slavery.

The Governor of Alabama, in a message to the Legislature, suggests the enactment of a law to prevent the separation of husband and wife, and parent from children, in the sale of slaves.

A bill in relation to the sale of slave mothers and their children is now before the legislature of Georgia. It provides that no slave children under five years of age shall be separated from their mother, by any kind of sale whatever, legal or otherwise, unless, in legally dividing an estate, it shall be found impossible to effect a division without such a separation.

The Richmond Enquirer disapproves of legislation on this subject. Referring to the recommendation of the Governor of Alabama, that paper says.

There is no necessity for any such law in restraint of the right of the master, as is suggested by the Governor of Alabama. The suggestion implies the prevalence of an evil which does not exist to any extent, and thus does injustice to the moral sentiment of the slaveholding community. The proper remedy for this, as for every other evil incident to the condition of slavery, is not to be found in compulsory legislation, but in the voluntary action of an enlightened public sentiment. Excessive cruelty is as rare in the South as crime of a far more heinous character, and is as fatal to the social position of the master. And in a few years the violent disregard of the family relations of the slave would be as uncommon as the more outrageous occurrences of physical cruelty and oppression. It is as unnecessary as it is perilous, to tamper with the relation of master and slave.

Public Lands.

It is calculated that the bills introduced in the first three weeks of the session contemplate a cession to the States or to railroad companies of over one hundred and twenty millions of acres of public land. The antagonism between these schemes and the equitable division proposed by Mr. Bennett is evident. The entire amount of the grants proposed in his bill is 59,400,000 acres. It is the only project by which the old States which have paid for the original acquisition of the lands, and now pay more than their proportion for managing them, can expect to secure any part of that magnificent public property which is about to be distributed.